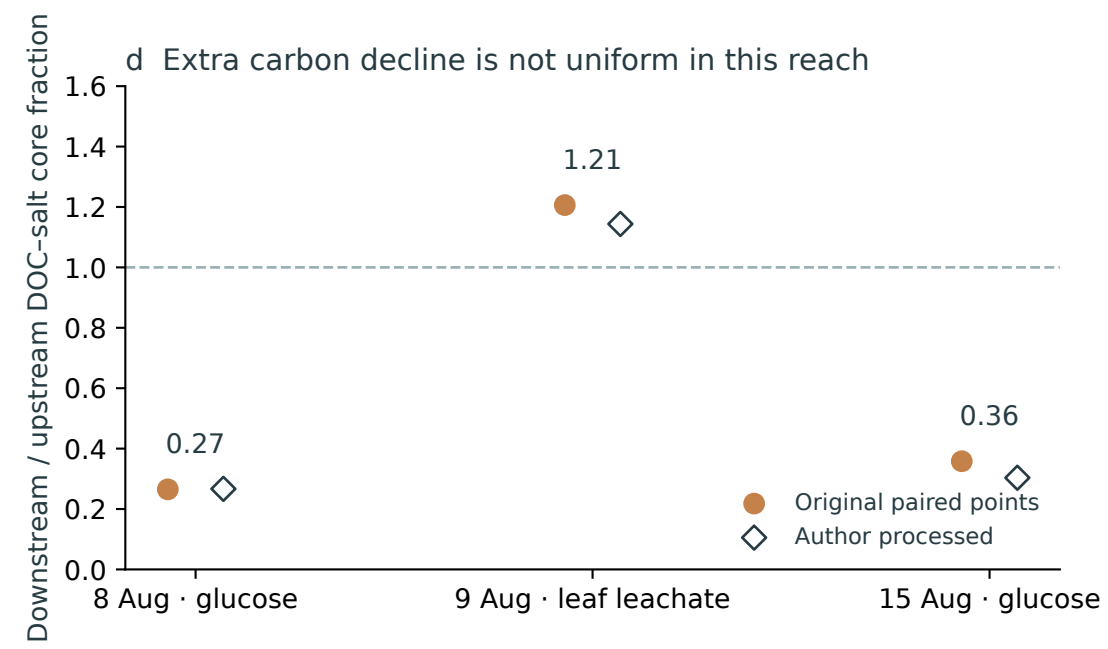
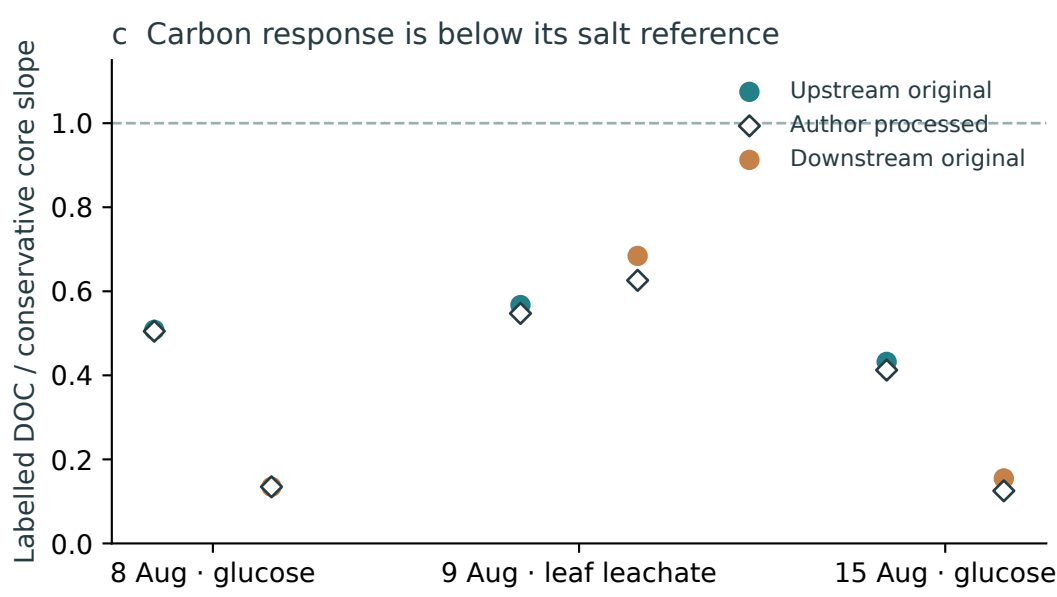
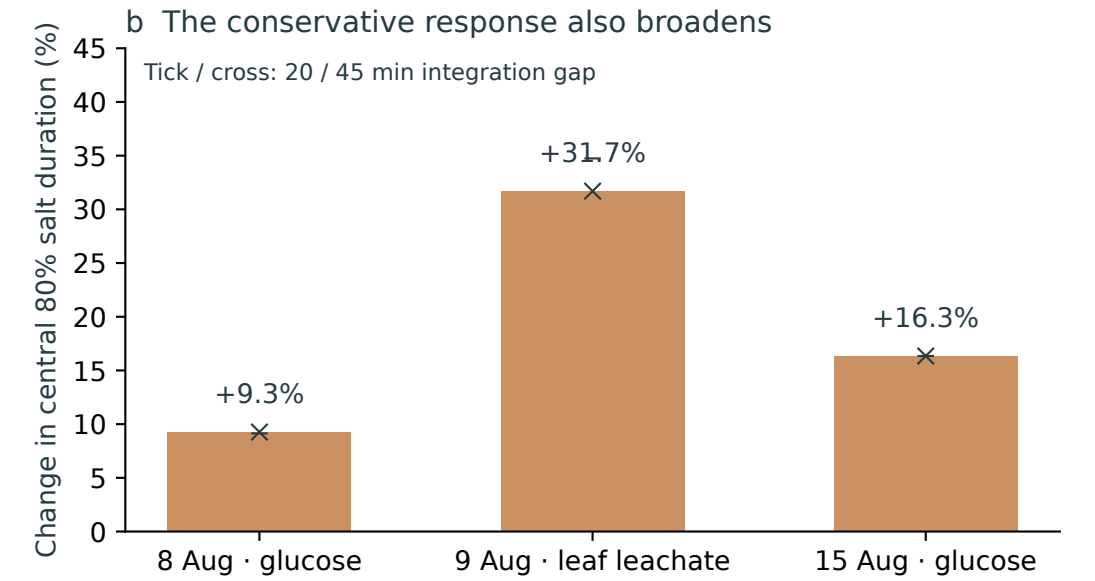
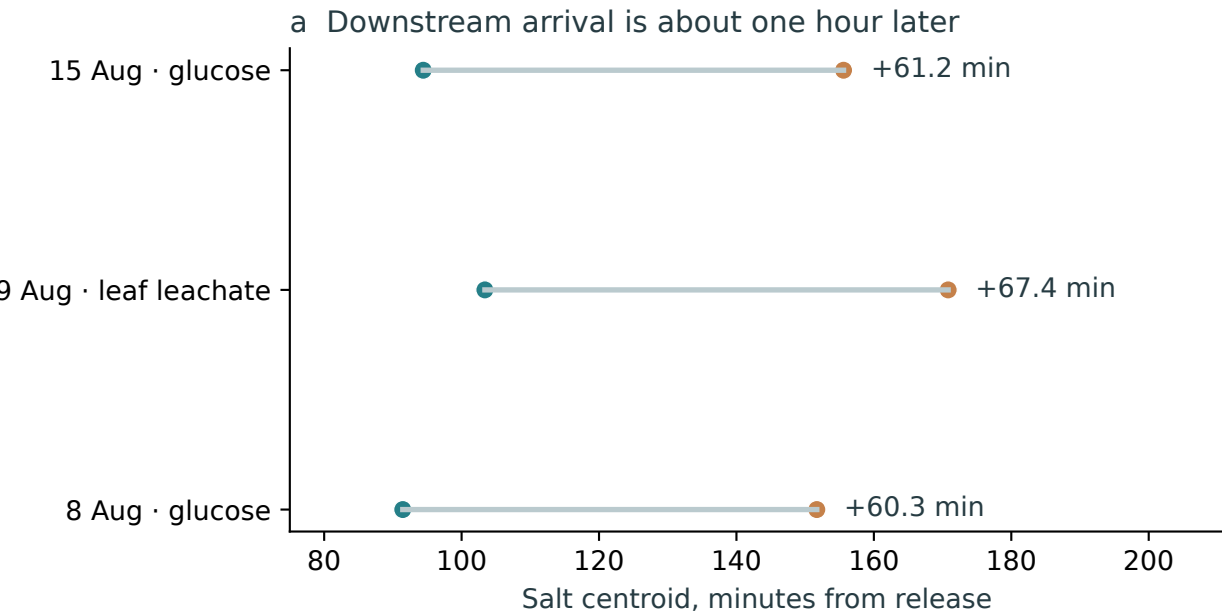


# Transport and carbon processing are separate operations

Teal: upstream sampling site. Orange: downstream sampling site. All three addition dates in the same reach are retained.



a/b: salt response within the observed 0-300 min window. c: vertical ranges are background/core-threshold sensitivity, not confidence intervals. d < 1 indicates an additional relative DOC response decline; > 1 alone does not demonstrate DOC production. Salt concentration attenuation includes dilution and spreading. This reach tests the process link, not a ranking of three whole-network forms.